Sources:

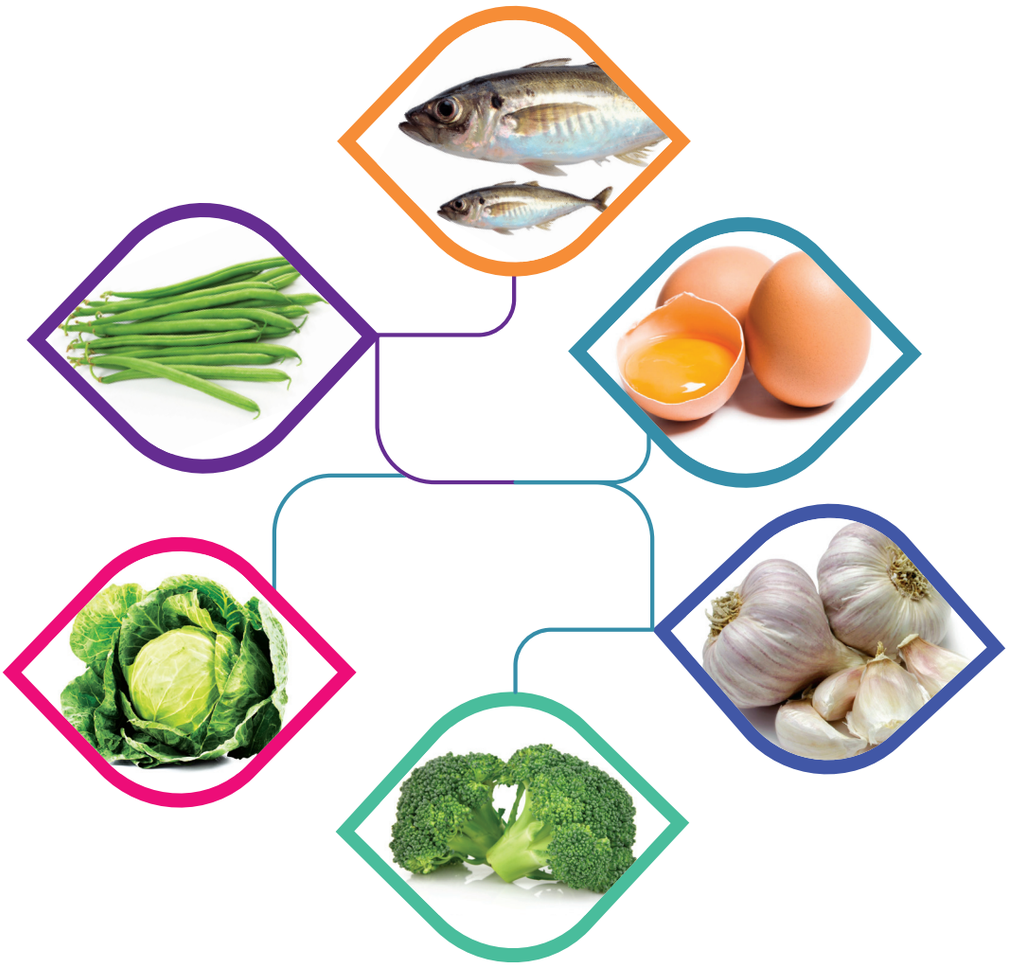


Figure 9.1 Sources of calcium

Dairy products remain one of the most important dietary sources of calcium. Other sources include egg-yolk, beans and cabbage.

Absorption:

Calcium is taken in the diet as calcium salts of phosphate, carbonate, tartrate and oxalate. Calcium is actively absorbed in the upper small intestine.

Factors affecting calcium absorption:

Many factors are said to influence the absorption of the calcium in the intestine. They are:

1. **pH:** An acidic pH favours calcium absorption.

2. **Protein:** A high protein diet favours the absorption of calcium.

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